ZENCODE

SOFTWARE LABS

BRAND GUIDELINES.

The logo, colours, type, graphic language and voice that make Zencode look and sound like Zencode, wherever it shows up.

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01 / WHO WE ARE

YOU THINK IT. WE BUILD IT.

Zencode Software Labs is an independent design and software studio based in Malaysia. We build websites, custom business software, AI and workflow automation, and new digital products.

We work with independent brands, specialist teams and industrial operations. Every project starts with a real business need, not a package or a price list.

01

WEBSITES & DIGITAL EXPERIENCES

A stronger presence. A clearer story.

02

CUSTOM SOFTWARE & PLATFORMS

A better way to get the work done.

03

AI & WORKFLOW AUTOMATION

Useful where it counts, with the right human oversight.

04

IDEAS, PROTOTYPES & PRODUCTS

Give your "what if" a first version.

PERSONALITY

Confident, hands-on, plain-spoken, a little playful.

PROMISE

A clearer, more dependable way of working, built to fit.

NOT

Corporate, jargon-heavy, or hype about "AI everything".

02 / THE LOGO

BUILT FROM TRACES

The wordmark is drawn the way a circuit is routed: rounded tracks, each carrying a live coral trace that ends in a node. It reads ZENCODE, and the centre dot stands in for the O.



Primary lockup: wordmark + "Software Labs" descriptor, cream on charcoal

File: assets/fullLogoV2.svg

03 / LOGO ANATOMY

HOW IT'S MADE



1 TRACKS

Heavy cream strokes with fully rounded ends. Corners are hard 90° turns; the C and D use 60° chevrons.

2 TRACES

A thin coral line runs down the centre of every track, like a signal through a wire.

3 THE DOT

The only solid coral shape. It is the O in ZENCODE and the "zen" pause at the centre.

4 NODES

Every trace ends in a small node. This detail becomes our main graphic device.

5 DESCRIPTOR

"Software Labs" in pixel-cut capitals, widely tracked to the full width of the wordmark.

04 / LOGO VERSIONS

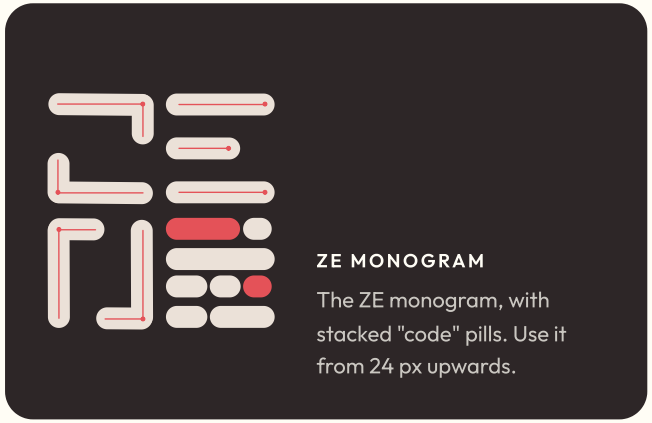
PICK THE RIGHT ONE

Use the full lockup wherever there's room. Use the ZE monogram for small or square spaces: app icons, avatars, favicons and stamps. Charcoal is the home background; use the others when the layout calls for it.



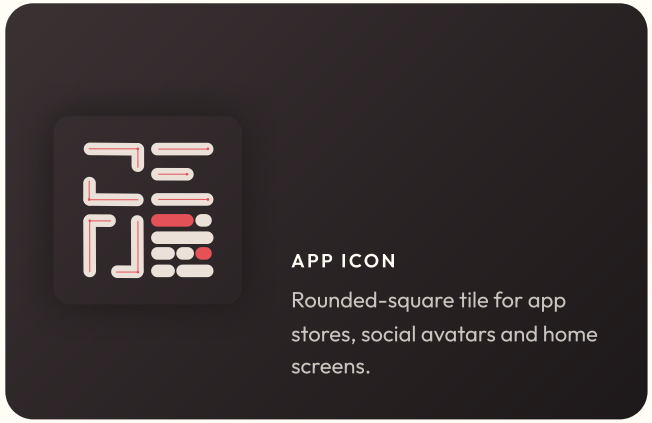






ZE MONOGRAM

The ZE monogram, with stacked "code" pills. Use it from 24 px upwards.



APP ICON

Rounded-square tile for app stores, social avatars and home screens.



ONE COLOUR

For embossing, engraving, single-ink print and fax.

05 / CLEAR SPACE & MINIMUM SIZE

GIVE IT ROOM



Clear space = x, where x is the height of one track (the thickness of the Z's top bar). Keep text, edges and other graphics outside this zone.



120 px / 30 mm
Full lockup minimum. Below this, "Software Labs" stops being readable.



80 px / 20 mm
Below 120 px, drop the descriptor and use the wordmark only.



24 px / 6 mm
ZE monogram minimum. For 16 px favicons use the prepared favicon files.

06 / LOGO MISUSE

PLEASE DON'T

The logo is drawn precisely. Always use the supplied files and never redraw, rearrange or restyle them. If none of the versions fits, ask before improvising.



✕ Stretch or squash it



✕ Rotate or tilt it



✕ Change the colours



✕ Add shadows, glows or effects



✕ Place it on busy or low-contrast backgrounds



✕ Use coral traces on coral (use the accent version)



✕ Re-type or rearrange the descriptor



✕ Box it in or crowd it with other elements

07 / COLOUR

WARM, DARK, ONE SPARK

Charcoal and cream do most of the work. Coral is the spark: it marks what matters, like the traces and nodes in the logo. Peach and mist are quiet supporting tones.

CHARCOAL

Primary background · text on light

HEX #2D2627
RGB 45 38 39
CMYK 0 16 13 82

CREAM

Text on dark · light backgrounds

HEX #FFFDF5
RGB 255 253 245
CMYK 0 1 4 0

CORAL

Accent · highlights · calls to action

HEX #E45258
RGB 228 82 88
CMYK 0 64 61 11

PEACH

Soft accent

HEX #E2B6A1
RGB 226 182 161
CMYK 0 19 29 11

MIST

Muted text on dark

HEX #C5BABB
RGB 197 186 187
CMYK 0 6 5 23

DEEP CORAL

Coral text on light

HEX #B83139
RGB 184 49 57
CMYK 0 73 69 28

CHARCOAL 58% | CREAM 27% | CORAL 10% | 5%

Rough balance across a layout. CMYK values are conversions; proof print jobs against the HEX swatch.

08 / COLOUR PAIRINGS

MAKE IT READABLE

Contrast ratios against WCAG 2.2. Body text needs 4.5:1. Coral on charcoal and cream on coral pass only for large text (24 px+, or 19 px bold), so keep those for headlines and buttons.

AA

Cream on charcoal. The default for everything.

CREAM / CHARCOAL
AAA · ALL TEXT
14.5

AA

Charcoal on cream. Long reading and documents.

CHARCOAL / CREAM
AAA · ALL TEXT
14.5

AA

Peach on charcoal. Secondary labels.

PEACH / CHARCOAL
AAA · ALL TEXT
8.1

AA

Mist on charcoal. Captions and metadata.

MIST / CHARCOAL
AAA · ALL TEXT
7.8

AA

Deep coral on cream. Links and emphasis.

DEEP CORAL / CREAM
AA · ALL TEXT
5.8

AA

Charcoal on coral. Banners and buttons.

CHARCOAL / CORAL
AA LARGE ONLY
4.0

AA

Coral on charcoal. Headline words only.

CORAL / CHARCOAL
AA LARGE ONLY
4.0

AA

Cream on coral. Big type only.

CREAM / CORAL
AA LARGE ONLY
3.7

09 / TYPOGRAPHY

TWO VOICES

A tall condensed display face for impact, always in capitals, paired with a round geometric sans for reading. Both are free Google Fonts, so they work everywhere: web, slides and print.

DISPLAY · HEADLINES

BARLOW CONDENSED

ZEN 09

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ 0123456789 &?!

SEMIBOLD 600 BOLD 700 EXTRABOLD 800

BODY · INTERFACE

OUTFIT

Aa

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789 (&@#%?!)

Light 300 Regular 400 **Medium 500** **Semibold 600**

Fallbacks: Arial Narrow for display, Arial or the system sans-serif for body. Download both at fonts.google.com.

10 / TYPE IN USE

THE HIERARCHY

HERO	BIG TALK?	Barlow Cond. 800 · caps line-height 0.88
HEADLINE	SMALL SHOP. REAL BUILD.	Barlow Cond. 800 · caps one coral phrase max
TITLE	CUSTOM SOFTWARE & PLATFORMS	Barlow Cond. 700 · caps
EYEBROW	02 / THE RANGE	Outfit 600 · caps tracking 0.16em · numbered
LEAD	Websites, custom software and useful AI, for ambitious businesses and ideas worth making real.	Outfit 300 · 18–20 px line-height 1.45
BODY	When spreadsheets, inboxes and disconnected tools no longer fit, we build around the workflows that matter to your team.	Outfit 300–400 · 14–16 px line-height 1.55–1.6
LABEL	VIEW PROJECT →	Outfit 500 · 10–11 px · caps

11 / GRAPHIC ELEMENTS

THE TOOLKIT

Every device comes from the logo: tracks, traces, nodes and pills. Use them sparingly as structure and signals, never as wallpaper.



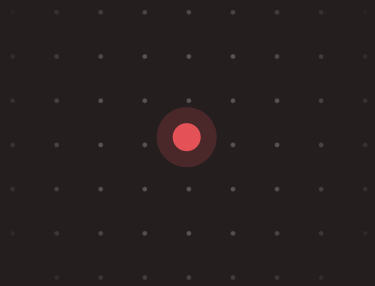
TRACE & NODE

A 2 px coral line ending in an 8 px dot. Use it for dividers, pointers, progress and connections.



CODE PILLS

Stacked capsules from the monogram, like lines of code. Good for loaders, placeholders and pattern.



GLYPH FIELD

A quiet dot grid that comes alive around the cursor on the website. In print, use it as texture.

01 / SELECTED WORK

02 / THE RANGE

03 / WHAT WE DO

NUMBERED LABELS

Sections are counted, like a well-commented file: "01 / Label", in coral capitals.

START A PROJECT →

SEE THE WORK

AI AGENT

DASHBOARD

WEBSITE

BUTTONS & TAGS

Fully rounded pills. Coral fill for the main action, outline for secondary, soft fill for tags.



DIE-CUT STICKERS

Logos and marks get a traced outline that follows their shape, as in the website's client section.

12 / VOICE & TONE

TALK LIKE A BUILDER

We sound like the person who'll actually build the thing: clear, direct and warm, with a bit of wit. Short sentences. Real outcomes. No buzzword soup.

01

PLAIN, NOT TECHNICAL

Explain what it does for the business before how it works. If a client wouldn't say the word, we don't either.

02

HONEST, NOT HYPED

AI where it's useful, with a human in the loop. We don't over-promise, invent numbers or call illustrations real data.

03

CONFIDENT, NOT CORPORATE

A small studio that's proud of it. Punchy headlines, a little play ("Big talk? Small shop."), and an easy next step.

WE SAY

"You think it. We build it."

"A better way to get the work done."

"Give your 'what if' a first version."

"We start with a real task, then work out whether AI can help."

WE DON'T SAY

~~"Leveraging cutting-edge synergies"~~

~~"End-to-end AI-powered digital transformation"~~

~~"World-class, best-in-class solutions"~~

~~"Packages from RM999!"~~

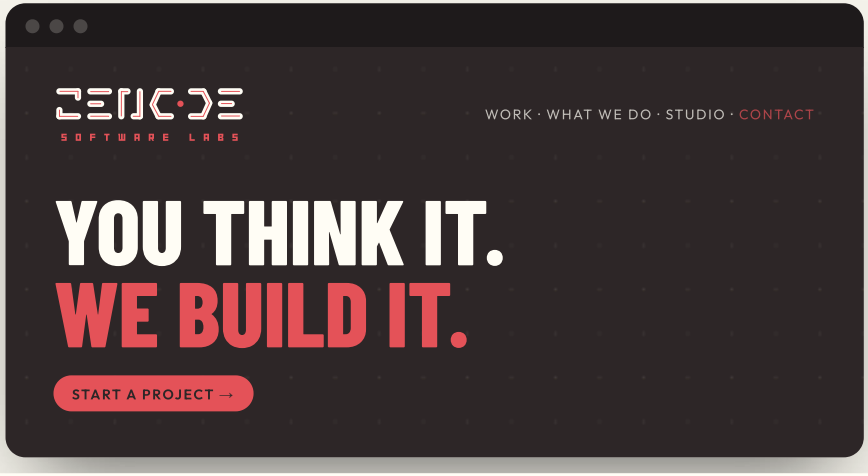
13 / APPLICATIONS

PUTTING IT TOGETHER











QUESTIONS ABOUT THE BRAND?

Ask before improvising. For logo files, fonts or anything not covered here, get in touch.

INFO@ZENCODE.MY • ZENCODE.MY • @ZENCODE.MY